

Xinyi Li

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Development Economics, Spatial Economics

EDUCATION

<i>University of Notre Dame</i>	Notre Dame, IN
Ph.D. in Economics	May 2027 (exp)
M.A. in Economics	2023
<i>Central University of Finance and Economics (CUFE)</i>	Beijing, China
M.S. in Finance	2020
B.S. in Economics	2017

AFFILIATIONS

Building Inclusive Growth (BIG) Lab, University of Notre Dame	2024–present
Kellogg Institute for International Studies, University of Notre Dame	2023–present

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Place-Based Policy Through Land: Firm Selection, Spatial Misallocation, and Rural-Urban Redistribution” 2026

Abstract: This paper studies how the preferential allocation of urban land to industrial use affects productivity, aggregate output and welfare through firm selection and rural-urban migration, using China’s primary urban land market as an empirical setting. The data suggests that prefectures where industrial land is cheaper allocate more land and employment to manufacturing and sustain more firms, yet have lower average productivity and only modestly higher manufacturing output. In particular, the discounted industrial land sustains marginal unproductive firms and weakens selection, with rural migrants account for much of the greater manufacturing employment in these prefectures. The paper then develops a spatial equilibrium model with heterogenous firms, rural-urban migration and land allocation to quantify the aggregate and distributional impacts of land price wedge. Eliminating within-prefecture land price wedge reduces manufacturing output by 5.2% but raises average productivity by about 7%, which are primarily drive by improved firm selection. The welfare impacts are distributional: urban welfare increases by 2.3%, driven mainly by lower housing prices, whereas rural welfare falls by 0.6% as urban manufacturing labor demand contracts. Furthermore, the inefficiency lies primarily in where industrial land is allocated rather than its aggregate share. These findings imply that evaluating place-based industrial policy requires considering not only output and employment, but also which firms produce, where production occurs, and who gains or loses.

WORK IN PORGRESS

“Energy Transitions and Their Distributional Impacts: 2005 and 2050” (with Danchen Zhao)
“How Free is Free Entry” (with Dario Cardamone and Benjamin Pugsley)
“Kill Competition for Low Price? Evidence from China’s Drug Procurement” (with Yiren Ding)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Heitor S. Pellegrina, University of Notre Dame	2023–2025
Full-time Research Assistant to Prof. Yongmiao Hong, Xiamen University	2020–2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Principles of Microeconomics, University of Notre Dame	Fall & Summer 2026
Teaching Assistant, Statistics for Economics, University of Notre Dame	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Econometrics II, University of Notre Dame	Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Macroeconomics I, University of Notre Dame	Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant, Principles of Economics, CUFE	Spring 2020 & Fall 2019

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grants	2025
BIG Lab Ph.D. Research Grant	2025
Kellogg Institute Professionalization Grants	2024

PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association (SEA)	2025
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SKILLS

Programming: Matlab, Stata, ArcGIS, Julia, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

PERSONALS

Citizenship: China

REFERENCES

Benjamin Pugsley (Chair)

Robert and Irene Bozzone Associate Professor
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University of Notre Dame
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Heitor S. Pellegrina

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Last updated: September 14, 2026